Leadership Mindset Syllabus

Junior High

2026–2027

INSTRUCTOR INFORMATION

Instructor	Email	Room Location & Hours
Dan Hegelund	Dan@rivertech.me	Upper Middle School Room — Tuesdays, 10:25–11:05 AM

GENERAL INFORMATION

Description

This is a four-quarter, workbook-based leadership course for junior high students, built around seven foundational habits. Each quarter has its own theme and guiding question — Lead Yourself, Lead Your Life, Lead With Others, and Lead for Life — and moves through a workbook chapter by chapter, with a short reading and reflection questions due each week.

Course Rhythm

Each quarter runs seven core teaching weeks; the remaining weeks are intentionally left open for tests, recap, games, missed classes, projects, or deeper discussion. The workbook is a tool — not a race to finish every page.

COURSE MATERIALS

Required Materials

- The leadership workbook (provided by the instructor)
- Something to write with, for weekly reading questions

QUARTER 1: LEAD YOURSELF

Can I lead myself before I try to lead anyone else?

Foundation: habits, mindset, principles, self-trust, and responsibility.

Tuesday due dates, 2026. Complete the reading and questions before class. Quarterly assessment: Week 7.

Week / Due	Workbook Chapter	Pages	Leadership Focus	Homework Due
1 — Sept. 8	Ch. 1 — Get in the Habit + start Ch. 2	1–~10	What habits are; why they matter; introducing mindset and paradigms	Read pp. 1–~10 and answer the questions.
2 — Sept. 15	Ch. 2 — Paradigms & Principles	~11–20	How our lens shapes choices; principles and life centers	Read pp. ~11–20 and answer the questions.
3 — Sept. 22	Ch. 3 — Personal Bank Account	21–28	Self-trust; deposits and withdrawals	Read pp. 21–28 and answer the questions.
4 — Sept. 29	Ch. 3 — Personal Bank Account	29–36	Character; keeping promises to yourself	Read pp. 29–36 and answer the questions.
5 — Oct. 6	Ch. 4 — Habit 1: Be Proactive	37–45	Reactive vs. proactive thinking and behavior	Read pp. 37–45 and answer the questions.
6 — Oct. 13	Ch. 4 — Habit 1	46–54	Choice, responsibility, and the circle of control	Read pp. 46–54 and answer the questions.
7 — Oct. 20	Ch. 4 — Habit 1	55–62	Initiative; applying proactivity to real life	Read pp. 55–62 and answer the questions. Essay due.

Quarter 1 Assessment — Week 7 — October 20, 2026

Write a 2–3 page essay about Foundation: habits, mindset, principles, self-trust, and responsibility.

Course launch: September 1. Open week after the assessment: October 27.

COURSE LAUNCH

Before Week 1: What is leadership? What is mindset? Why must a good leader also know how to follow? Preview the four-quarter journey.

By the End of This Quarter, Students Should Be Able To:

- Explain habits, paradigms, and principles.
- Recognize how mindset influences behavior and results.
- Build self-trust through choices and commitments.
- Practice proactive responses, responsible language, and initiative.

Course rhythm: seven core teaching weeks per quarter. Remaining weeks are intentionally open for tests, recap, games, missed classes, projects, or deeper discussion. The workbook is a tool — not a race to finish every page.

QUARTER 2: LEAD YOUR LIFE

Where am I going, and what deserves my time?

Direction: vision, goals, priorities, discipline, and the transition into relationships.

Tuesday due dates, 2026–27. Complete the reading and questions before class. Quarterly assessment: Week 7.

Week / Due	Workbook Chapter	Pages	Leadership Focus	Homework Due
1 — Nov. 3	Ch. 5 — Habit 2: Begin with	63–69	Vision and direction: what does "the end" mean?	Read pp. 63–69 and answer the questions.

Week / Due	Workbook Chapter	Pages	Leadership Focus	Homework Due
	the End in Mind			
2 — Nov. 10	Ch. 5 — Habit 2	70–76	Identity and future self: who do I want to become?	Read pp. 70–76 and answer the questions.
3 — Nov. 17	Ch. 5 — Habit 2	77–83	Goals: turning vision into something concrete	Read pp. 77–83 and answer the questions.
4 — Dec. 1	Ch. 5 — Habit 2	84–90	Mission, values, and personal direction	Read pp. 84–90 and answer the questions.
5 — Dec. 8	Ch. 6 — Habit 3: Put First Things First	91–99	Important vs. urgent; priorities and "big rocks"	Read pp. 91–99 and answer the questions.
6 — Dec. 15	Ch. 6 — Habit 3	100–108	Planning, discipline, procrastination, and saying no	Read pp. 100–108 and answer the questions.
7 — Jan. 5	Ch. 7 — Relationship Bank Account	109–120	Trust in relationships; deposits and withdrawals	Read pp. 109–120 and answer the questions. Written test in class.

Quarter 2 Assessment — Week 7 — January 5, 2027

A written test about Direction: vision, goals, priorities, discipline, and the transition into relationships.

No school: November 24, December 22, and December 29. Open week after the assessment: January 12.

QUARTER ARC

Decide what matters → choose a direction → organize life around it → build trust with others.

By the End of This Quarter, Students Should Be Able To:

- Describe a meaningful future instead of simply reacting to the present.
- Set goals connected to values and long-term direction.
- Distinguish important work from merely urgent work.
- Practice planning, discipline, and trust-building behavior.

Course rhythm: seven core teaching weeks per quarter. Remaining weeks are intentionally open for tests, recap, games, missed classes, projects, or deeper discussion. The workbook is a tool — not a race to finish every page.

QUARTER 3: LEAD WITH OTHERS

How do I become someone people can trust, follow, and work with?

Public leadership: cooperation, listening, communication, teamwork, leadership, and followership.

Tuesday due dates, 2027. Complete the reading and questions before class. Quarterly assessment: Week 7.

Week / Due	Workbook Chapter	Pages	Leadership Focus	Homework Due
1 — Jan. 19	Ch. 8 — Habit 4: Think Win-Win	121–127	Win-Win and the alternatives: Win-Lose, Lose-Win, Lose-Lose	Read pp. 121–127 and answer the questions.
2 — Jan. 26	Ch. 8 — Habit 4	128–134	Courage +	Read pp. 128–134 and answer

Week / Due	Workbook Chapter	Pages	Leadership Focus	Homework Due
			consideration; healthy conflict and cooperation	the questions.
3 — Feb. 2	Ch. 9 — Habit 5: Seek First to Understand	135–144	Listening: why we often listen poorly	Read pp. 135–144 and answer the questions.
4 — Feb. 9	Ch. 9 — Habit 5	145–154	Understand first; then communicate clearly	Read pp. 145–154 and answer the questions.
5 — Feb. 23	Ch. 10 — Habit 6: Synergize	155–162	Differences as strengths	Read pp. 155–162 and answer the questions.
6 — Mar. 2	Ch. 10 — Habit 6	163–170	Collaboration: creating something better together	Read pp. 163–170 and answer the questions.
7 — Mar. 9	Ch. 10 — Habit 6	171–178	Team roles, leadership, and followership	Read pp. 171–178 and answer the questions. Presentation due.

Quarter 3 Assessment — Week 7 — March 9, 2027

A public speaking presentation with slideshow on Public leadership: cooperation, listening, communication, teamwork, leadership, and followership.

No school: February 16 and March 30. Open weeks after the assessment: March 16 and March 23.

LEADERSHIP + FOLLOWERSHIP

A mature leader does not need to be in charge all the time. Strong leaders can receive direction, support another person's vision, disagree respectfully, and strengthen the team from any position.

By the End of This Quarter, Students Should Be Able To:

- Look for solutions in which people can succeed together.
- Listen to understand before trying to persuade.
- Use differences in ideas, personalities, and strengths productively.
- Recognize when to lead, follow, support, or collaborate.

Course rhythm: seven core teaching weeks per quarter. Remaining weeks are intentionally open for tests, recap, games, missed classes, projects, or deeper discussion. The workbook is a tool — not a race to finish every page.

QUARTER 4: LEAD FOR LIFE

How do I keep becoming the person I want to be?

Renewal: body, mind, heart, spirit, resilience, hope, and integration of all seven habits.

Tuesday due dates, 2027. Complete the reading and questions before class. Quarterly assessment: Week 7.

Week / Due	Workbook Chapter	Pages	Leadership Focus	Homework Due
1 — Apr. 6	Ch. 11 — Habit 7: Sharpen the Saw	179–189	Renewal and balance: why leaders need restoration	Read pp. 179–189 and answer the questions.
2 — Apr. 13	Ch. 11 — Habit 7	190–201	Body + mind: health, learning, attention, and growth	Read pp. 190–201 and answer the

Week / Due	Workbook Chapter	Pages	Leadership Focus	Homework Due
				questions.
3 — Apr. 20	Ch. 11 — Habit 7	202–212	Heart + soul/spirit: relationships, meaning, and inner life	Read pp. 202–212 and answer the questions.
4 — Apr. 27	Ch. 12 — Keep Hope Alive	213–221	Hope, setbacks, and possibility	Read pp. 213–221 and answer the questions.
5 — May 4	Ch. 12 — Keep Hope Alive	222–230	Resilience and perseverance	Read pp. 222–230 and answer the questions.
6 — May 11	Ch. 12 — Keep Hope Alive	231–240	Moving forward and applying what has been learned	Read pp. 231–240 and answer the questions.
7 — May 18	Chs. 1–12 — Integration	Review	The complete Leadership Mindset: all seven habits working together	Review the earlier pages and your answers. Written test in class.

Quarter 4 Assessment — Week 7 — May 18, 2027

A written test about Renewal: body, mind, heart, spirit, resilience, hope, and integration of all seven habits.

Open week after the assessment: May 25. June 1 is tentatively Silverwood Day; no homework is scheduled for it.

COURSE MOTTO

See differently. Choose differently. Lead differently.

By the End of This Quarter, Students Should Be Able To:

- Renew body, mind, heart, and spirit in practical ways.
- Respond to setbacks with resilience rather than resignation.
- Explain how the seven habits work together as a system.
- Describe the kind of leader — and person — they want to become.

Course rhythm: seven core teaching weeks per quarter. Remaining weeks are intentionally open for tests, recap, games, missed classes, projects, or deeper discussion. The workbook is a tool — not a race to finish every page.